



Thai basil

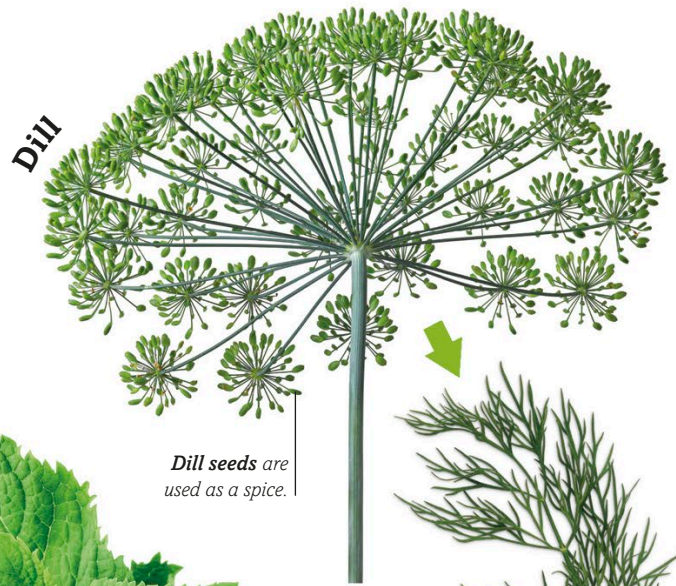
Spicy leaves taste like licorice and are used in Asian cooking.

In the past, these hairy, gray-green leaves were used to ward off evil.



Mint

These leaves are used in toothpaste and sweets.



Dill

Dill seeds are used as a spice.

These delicate, feathery leaves are often eaten with seafood.

Dill leaves



Sage

The leaves are used for flavoring food.



Rosemary

Needlelike rosemary leaves grow on woody plants that can reach up to 7 ft (2 m) tall.



Chives

The hollow, tubular stems taste like onion—and the flowers do, too!

In the Middle Ages, herb gardens were common in European monasteries: monks grew **sage** as a remedy and also to clean their teeth. The plant's scientific name, *Salvia*, comes from the Latin for "I am well." **Oregano** is also healing. In Chinese medicine, it is used to help digestive problems.

Modern science has proven some of the qualities of herbs—**mint** oil is known to kill mosquito larvae, for example. Other ideas are based on superstition, such as the medieval practice of drinking **dill** tea to repel a witch's curse.